

2 TOC, respectively. This falls in well with our document style guideline of using *Heading 1* and *Heading 2* as Level 1 and Level 2 headings, respectively. Also, bump up the *Chapter threshold* number to a value larger than the number of chapters in your Ebook.

Final lap

Before you click 'OK', remember to choose the 'Output Format' as EPUB on the top right of the screen. Calibre will start the conversion process, and flag its completion. Your EPUB Ebook should be stored in your Calibre library (remember the location you specified earlier) in a folder named after its author, and will have the extension '.epub'.

There is one last thing to be done to tweak the metadata of the Ebook. I could not get my version of Calibre (0.6.13) to populate the language attribute automatically. If your version has a similar problem, then you can use the command-line tool that is part of the Calibre installation. Issue the following command and you are done:

```
$ ebook-meta <EPUB file> -l en
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Checking standards compliance

It is very important to check your EPUB Ebook for standards compliance. This will help your Ebook fulfil its potential by being rendered correctly on a wide variety of Ebook readers. Open the EPUB validation site in your browser, upload your Ebook, and start the validation. Again, nothing short of an unqualified *Pass* should be your target. Congratulations! You have created your DRM-free EPUB Ebook!

Serving EPUB Ebooks

Now that you know how to create your own Ebooks, and also to create a repository of other Ebooks that you might have downloaded, would it not be logical to make them available over the Intranet to your colleagues (of course, keeping in mind the applicable licensing conditions)? Calibre has one more surprise in its feature list; it has a Web server, based on CherryPy, which listens on port 8080 on *localhost*. Bring up the *Preferences* window, and select the *Content Server* screen. There is very little to change here, except providing a login ID and password (recommended) before clicking on *Start Server*. Once the server is up, point your browser to <http://localhost:8080> and see your collection of books arranged on a Web page. Since you already have the Firefox add-on to read EPUB Ebooks, it is just a matter of clicking an Ebook hyperlink, and reading it right in your browser.

A direct approach

Sigil is a WYSIWYG editor for EPUB. It lets you work directly and interactively with the XHTML in the EPUB container. Before using Sigil, it is worth reading the documentation and its tutorial at the wiki, which not only introduces you to the EPUB format, but also guides you on

how to create an Ebook, edit its metadata, and customise its TOC. Working directly with HTML gives you greater flexibility, but can also bog you down in mark-up details.

You can import text or HTML into Sigil, and start editing it after the four-step process of editing the TOC, editing the metadata, confirming images and any tables. You can also author the book directly using the Sigil editor. Once you have clean XHTML after following the steps described earlier, you can take either the Sigil or the Calibre route. However, a hybrid approach might serve your purpose, in most cases. You can use the Calibre-based workflow we described earlier to produce your Ebook, and later use Sigil to customise it to your requirements, by adding additional metadata fields or tuning the placement of images. Irrespective of the approach you use, remember to run a validation test on your completed work.

Epilogue

EPUB produced with our workflow passes the EPUB validation tests, and renders well on Calibre's own Ebook reader, as well as the Firefox EPUB add-on. Your mileage may vary, depending on your Ebook reader. Once you are comfortable with producing EPUB Ebooks with this workflow, and are fascinated enough to continue further, you can experiment with the Ebook production process. The Calibre command-line interface lets you automate the conversion process. You can also try out things such as adding custom CSS for a unique look-and-feel, placing images as part of chapter headings and TOC items, or creating custom title pages.

Now, dear author-publisher, have you caught the scent of that Ebook? 

References

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- [5] http://validator.w3.org/#validate_by_upload+with_options The W3 Markup Validation Service.
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- [8] <http://code.google.com/p/sigil/> Sigil, a WYSIWYG Ebook editor

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